Art for
ANXIOUS DAYS

VOL. 1

11 drawings & small kindnesses for heavy-headed days



Hi, you.

This little book is made of pages from my sketchbook, most of them drawn on days when my head felt too loud.

Drawing is the thing that slows me down. Once I'm in the zone, the noise gets quieter. I wanted to pass a bit of that quiet on to you.

How to use it: open any page. You don't have to read it in order, and you don't have to finish it. Every drawing comes with one tiny thing to try. Do it, or don't. Both are fine.

Take what helps and leave the rest.

with love, from my sketchbook to yours



Dot, dot, dot

This one is thousands of tiny marks. I didn't plan it. I just kept going, one dot after another, until my head went quiet.

try this: Breathe in for four dots, out for six. Do it three times.



Sit like a cat

Cats don't explain themselves. They find a warm spot, sit very still and watch the world without needing to fix any of it.

try this: Drop your shoulders. Unclench your jaw. Stay like that for ten slow breaths.



The clock can wait

Some days every minute feels like it's chasing me. It isn't, really. It's just ticking, the way it always has.

try this: Set a timer for five minutes and do nothing at all until it rings.



Did you eat?

On heavy days the bravest thing can be a slice of toast and a glass of water. That counts. That really counts.

try this: Eat something warm, slowly, with your phone in another room.



Keep one small moment

An old camera taught me that you don't have to hold the whole day. Just one frame of it.

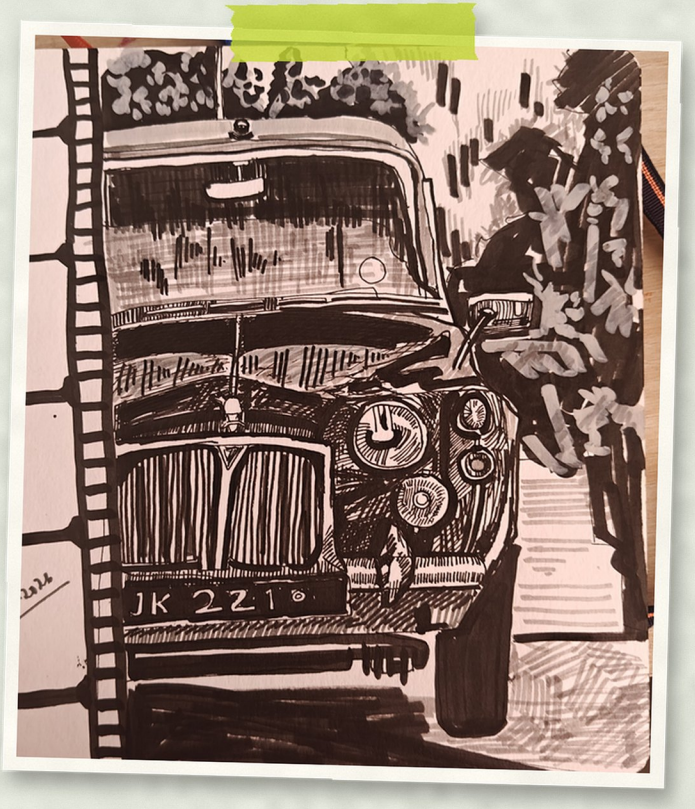
try this: Name five things you can see, four you can hear, three you can touch.



Parked, not stuck

Resting is not the same as falling behind. Even the loveliest car spends most of its life parked.

try this: Write down one thing you're allowed to not do today.



The slow lane is still a lane

You're still going somewhere, even when everyone else seems to be overtaking you.

try this: Walk somewhere at half your usual speed. Notice what you normally miss.



Bloom in pieces

These flowers are built from little broken tiles. Feeling scattered doesn't mean you aren't whole.

try this: List three small things that went okay this week.



Water the small things

Not everything needs fixing today. Some things just need a little water and some light.

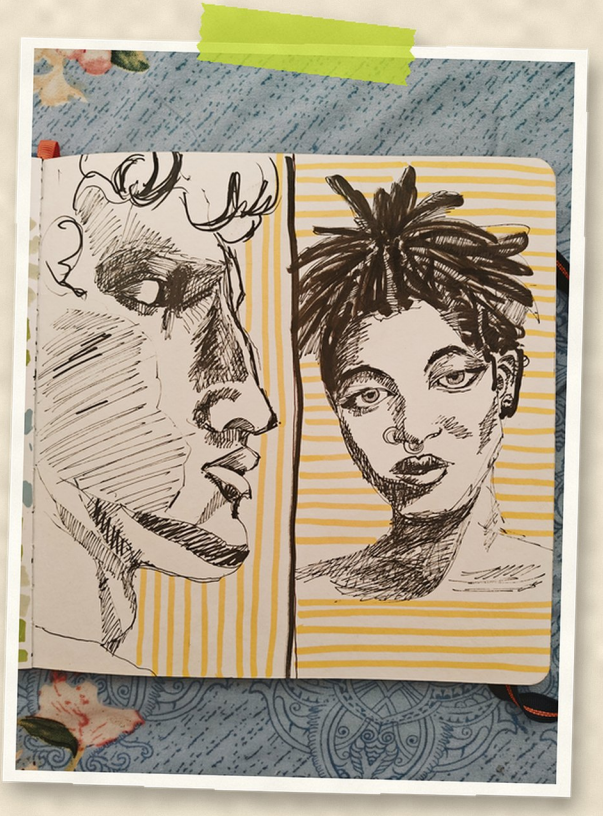
try this: Do one kind thing for your space: open a window, water a plant, make your bed.



Look away for a bit

You're allowed to look away: from the news, from the group chat, from the never-ending list.

try this: Put your phone down for twenty minutes. The world will keep.



Both of you are welcome

There's the face you show people and the face that's tired.
Neither one is the wrong one.

try this: Say one honest sentence about how you feel, even if it's only to yourself.



Breathe with the flowers

IN 4 — smell the flower

HOLD 4 — keep it close

OUT 6 — blow out a candle

Count slowly. Repeat four times. Your out-breath is longer than your in-breath on purpose: that's the part that tells your body it's safe.

Your page

Today I'm feeling:

One small thing that helped:

Something I'm looking forward to:

Draw it, doodle it, dot it:

Thank you

for buying this zine and for keeping my sketchbook going. Every copy means I get to spend more time drawing.

Vol. 2 is on its way

Keep your receipt: everyone who bought Vol. 1 gets first look at Vol. 2 and a returning-reader price.



This zine is a comfort, not a cure. If things feel too heavy, please talk to someone. In India you can call Tele-MANAS on 14416, free and any time of day.